

I WILL BUILD MY CHURCH

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: *Matthew 16:13-19 (NKJV)* “When Jesus came into the region of Caesarea Philippi, He asked His disciples, saying, “**Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?**”¹⁴ So they said, “Some say John the Baptist, some Elijah, and others Jeremiah or one of the prophets.”¹⁵ He said to them, “**But who do you say that I am?**”¹⁶ Simon Peter answered and said, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”¹⁷ Jesus answered and said to him, “**Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but My Father who is in heaven.**”¹⁸ “**And I also say to you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build My church, and the gates of Hades shall not prevail against it.**”¹⁹ “**And I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.**”

INTRO: In this passage of Scripture, Jesus makes a bold and forward thinking prediction concerning the Church He was about to birth. Really, this is the Vision statement for the New Testament Church!

Jesus lets us know that what He is predicting is not something which may or may not come to pass; it WILL be fulfilled!

I. THE POWER OF THE VISION IS BASED IN THE PERSON – “I”

The “I” here is the same “*I am*” which sent Moses to Egypt. He is the: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Eternal one...
- All powerful one...
- Self-existent one...
- All knowing one...
- Omnipresent one...

This is the same person which the prophet Isaiah spoke of! Isaiah 6:1-7 (NKJV) *“In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up, and the train of His robe filled the temple. ²Above it stood seraphim; each one had six wings: with two he covered his face, with two he covered his feet, and with two he flew. ³And one cried to another and said: “Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; The whole earth is full of His glory!” ⁴And the posts of the door were shaken by the voice of him who cried out, and the house was filled with smoke. ⁵So I said: “Woe is me, for I am undone! Because I am a man of unclean lips, And I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips; For my eyes have seen the King, The LORD of hosts.” ⁶Then one of the seraphim flew to me, having in his hand a live coal which he had taken with the tongs from the altar. ⁷And he touched my mouth with it, and said: “Behold, this has touched your lips; Your iniquity is taken away, And your sin purged.” ⁸Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying: “Whom shall I send, And*

who will go for Us?” Then I said, “Here am I! Send me.”

This is the same person which met with John the Revelator on the Island of Patmos. Revelation 1:8 (NKJV) *“**I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End,**” says **the Lord,** “**who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty.**”*

Jesus, the great “*I Am*” is the founder and finisher of the Church!

II. THE PROMISE OF THE FULFILLMENT OF THE VISION IS SECURE – “*I will*”

The verb “*will*” is in future tense! He is saying the building of the Church “*will*” unquestionably come to pass. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** The reason the construction of the Church is so secure is because He (Jesus) is the architect and builder!

Numbers 23:19 (NKJV) *“**God is not a man, that He should lie, Nor a son of man, that He should repent.** Has He said, and will He not do? Or has He spoken, and will He not make it good?”* 2 Corinthians 1:20 (NKJV) *“**For all the promises of God in Him are Yes, and in Him Amen, to the glory of God through us.**”*

III. THE PROCESS OF BUILDING THE CHURCH IS SUPERNATURAL – “*I will build*”

To begin with, no man can build God a church! He is building His own church! Some folks think they are the builder when in fact; we are the material being used in the construction process of the Church! Ephesians 2:19-22 (NKJV) ***"You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God,*** ²⁰***having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone,*** ²¹***in whom the whole building, being joined together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord,*** ²²***in whom you also are being built together for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.***"

IV. THE OWNERSHIP OF THE CHURCH IS DIVINE – "My Church"

Some folks want to own and operate the church! The proprietorship of the Church is not earthly it is Heavenly! If the ownership is earthly it will fail in complicated times; if it is Heavenly it will succeed without regard to difficulty! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Ephesians 4:11-16 (NKJV) ***"He Himself gave some to be apostles, some prophets, some evangelists, and some pastors and teachers,*** ¹²***for the equipping of the saints for the work of ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ,*** ¹³***till we all come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of***

Christ; ¹⁴that we should no longer be children, tossed to and fro and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the trickery of men, in the cunning craftiness of deceitful plotting, ¹⁵but, speaking the truth in love, may grow up in all things into Him who is the head—Christ—¹⁶from whom the whole body, joined and knit together by what every joint supplies, according to the effective working by which every part does its share, causes growth of the body for the edifying of itself in love.”

Colossians 1:18 (NKJV) *“He is the head of the body, the church, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things He may have the preeminence.”*

Many local churches struggle with a strong personality wanting to have ownership in the church. This is not a problem which is unique to our day; it has been going on since the foundation of the Church was initiated. John writes about this in his third letter, verse 9 (NKJV) *“I wrote to the church, but Diotrephes, who loves to have the preeminence among them, does not receive us.”*

ILLUSTRATION:

(Many years ago I was preaching and throughout my sermon I continued to state and restate *“This is not my church; this is not your church; this is God’s church!”* One lady finally responded by saying, *“This is my church!”* The sad part is, that it was her church, and it failed!

Any church owned and operated by man will fail!)

V. THE BEGINNING OF THE CHURCH WAS HUMBLE BUT THE END RESULT OF THE CHURCH WILL BE GLORIOUS!

“I will build my CHURCH!”

Three stages of the Church are clearly seen in

Scripture: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The concept of the Church was initiated in the age of guilt! Genesis 3:14-15 (NKJV) *“The LORD God said to the serpent: “Because you have done this, You are cursed more than all cattle, And more than every beast of the field; On your belly you shall go, And you shall eat dust All the days of your life. ¹⁵ And I will put enmity Between you and the woman, And between your seed and her Seed; He shall bruise your head, And you shall bruise His heel.”* Ephesians 1:4 (NKJV) *“He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before Him in love.”*
- The Church is being supernaturally constructed in the Dispensation of Grace! Colossians 3:1-4 (NKJV) *“If then you were raised with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ is, sitting at the right hand of God. ²Set your mind on things above, not on things on the earth. ³For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. ⁴When Christ who*

is our life appears, then you also will appear with Him in glory.”

- The completion of the Church will occur in the final age! Revelation 21:1-7 (NKJV) “Now I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away. Also there was no more sea. ²Then I, John, saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. ³And I heard a loud voice from heaven saying, “Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and He will dwell with them, and they shall be His people. God Himself will be with them and be their God.” ⁴“And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes; there shall be no more death, nor sorrow, nor crying. There shall be no more pain, for the former things have passed away.” ⁵Then He who sat on the throne said, “Behold, I make all things new.” And He said to me, “Write, for these words are true and faithful.” ⁶And He said to me, “It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. I will give of the fountain of the water of life freely to him who thirsts.” ⁷“He who overcomes shall inherit all things, and I will be his God and he shall be My son.”

CONCLUSION:

Jesus said, “*I will build my Church.*”

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- He has...

- He is...
- He will...

I want to be a part of His Church, don't you?